

# WELCOME TO THE DISC WORLD

*A quick primer for players new to Terry Pratchett's world*

**TONE:** dry, sarcastic, full of puns. Common sense is rare, so be polite to anyone carrying an axe, and never ask what's in the sausage.

## THE DISC

A flat world, balanced on the backs of **four elephants**, who stand on the shell of a giant turtle (**Great A'Tuin**) swimming through space. Everyone here thinks this is perfectly normal. It's fantasy, but with the clichés poked until they squeak.

- **Narrative Causality:** stories *want* to happen. One-in-a-million chances come up nine times out of ten, and the funnier or more dramatic option usually wins. Lean in.
- **Magic is real and can do anything, but should it?** If it results in something interesting it will probably cooperate, but never without some sort of mishap. Clever wizards quickly learn to use it only in times of need.
- **Directions:** there's no north or south. Travel is **hubwards** (toward the Disc's centre), **rimwards** (toward the edge), **turnwise** (with the Disc's spin) or **widdershins** (against it).
- **Belief is power.** Gods, ideas and monsters exist because enough people believe in them.

## ANKH-MORPORK

The biggest, smelliest, most cosmopolitan city on the Disc, and the home of nearly everyone you'll play. Sits on the **River Ankh**, so polluted it's crunchy, and you can almost walk across. Every species lives here, and gets along because everyone is equally mistrusted.

- **Lord Vetinari, the Patrician**, rules the city: a thin, calm, terrifying tyrant who is both feared *and* respected, and who somehow keeps the whole mess running. You do not want him to take an interest in you.
- **The Guilds run everything.** Rather than fight crime, the city regulates it:
  - **Thieves:** licensed, with a yearly quota. Pay your dues and you get a receipt, and nobody else will rob you.
  - **Assassins:** gentlemen and ladies of taste, with a dress code and rules of engagement. Murder is a profession like any other.
  - **Beggars:** licensed pitches and a strict pecking order. Don't even *think* of poaching a corner.
  - **Fools:** clowns and jesters, professionally trained. Funnier than they look, and pies are serious business.
  - **Seamstresses:** not to be confused with "needlewomen" (those who actually mend textiles). The guild instead provides ladies of negotiable affection.
- **The City Watch** is run by **Commander Vimes** and recruits from every species in the city. The members range from sharp to sleepy, and they're underfunded and rarely taken seriously (except by the criminals).
- **Unseen University** is where the wizards live, eat enormous meals, and are carefully ignored. The Librarian is an orangutan.

## YOU ARE A WEREWOLF

- **What you are:** a shapeshifter from Überwald (think fictional Transylvania). You're normally human and can change at will, but the **week of the full moon** forces you into wolf shape. Werewolves are mostly **born**, not made (it runs in bloodlines), though whether a bite can pass it on is disputed.
- **Forms:** as a human you have thumbs, better eyesight and the ability to think things through. As a wolf you have claws, quick combat reflexes and a nose so good you can "see" smells. Stay a wolf for too long and canine habits seep into your human form.
- **Weakness:** **silver** burns even on a light touch, and fire and decapitation also work. Anything else only seems to kill you, and you'll be back at the next full moon.
- **Culture:** werewolf homes have few furnishings, doors for both humans and dogs, and a pantry full of raw meat. Some refuse to wear clothes in human form.
- **Society:** noble werewolf families work like large clans, with as many werewolf barons in Überwald as vampire ones, and the two groups loathe each other.
- **Stereotypes:** *keen-nosed, a bit feral and torn between human reason and wolf instinct.* Most just make the best of it, even if the odd chicken goes missing once a month.
- **Names:** noble families use a *von* (Wolfgang von Überwald), but ordinary human names are common too.



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